

Alex Portugal

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Summary

Results-driven Technical Program Manager with 16+ years of experience leading high-impact initiatives across infrastructure, platform reliability, and customer-facing systems. Proven track record of delivering complex programs that improve service reliability, operational workflows, and customer experience for global 24x7x365 operations.

Expert in cross-functional team leadership, stakeholder alignment, and driving technical roadmap execution in complex, scalable environments. Strong background in incident management, ITSM, and process optimization with hands-on experience in AI-enhanced workflows, automation, and data-driven decision making. Bilingual (English/Spanish) and ITIL Expert certified with a passion for building trusted partnerships between engineering and business teams.

Core Competencies

- **Program & Project Management:** Agile delivery, multi-project management, cross-functional team leadership, stakeholder alignment, budget management, risk mitigation
 - **Technical Operations:** Enterprise platforms, Azure DevOps, ITSM (incident, change, problem management), process automation, workflow design, 24x7x365 operations
 - **Analytics & Reporting:** KPI reporting, executive dashboards, Power BI, data-driven decision making, performance analytics, financial impact analysis
 - **Leadership & Communication:** Cross-functional collaboration, requirements gathering, process improvement, change management, stakeholder engagement, vendor management
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Professional Experience

Technical Program Manager

Microsoft | Redmond, WA | March 2022 – June 2025

- **Led product development and operational strategy** for Digital Stores incident management, managing revenue-critical services with global impact across web, mobile, and native Windows applications
- **Created comprehensive dashboards for incident and financial impact analysis**, consolidating 50+ engineering monitors and enabling data-driven prioritization across engineering and business stakeholders

- **Managed vendor ecosystem** of 12+ suppliers providing 24x7x365 support, ensuring service delivery excellence through contract negotiations, performance monitoring, and continuous improvement initiatives
- **Developed and implemented KPI reporting frameworks** that reduced manual financial impact calculations from 3 hours to real-time automation, eliminating human errors and improving operational efficiency
- **Enhanced stakeholder communication strategy**, transforming technical incident details into business-digestible formats, improving leadership CSAT by 20% over 3 quarters
- **Coordinated with 100+ engineering teams** to define technical requirements, manage complex product launches, and reduce Time to Mitigate (TTM) by 15% through strategic partnership building
- **Drove process improvements** including planned maintenance communication enhancement, reducing unnecessary incident tickets by 10% through improved clarity and stakeholder alignment

Program Manager II / Major Incident Manager

Amazon | Seattle, WA | August 2021 – March 2022

- **Designed and deployed standard operating procedures (SOPs)** to improve enterprise-wide operational workflows and escalation management for internal dashboard platforms
- **Led resilience initiatives** across technical operations, delivering measurable improvements in system recovery metrics and platform reliability goals
- **Product managed development of monitoring dashboards** used by engineering and operations teams for performance tracking, early detection, and continuous improvement
- **Defined telemetry and success metrics** to drive feature improvements through usage data analysis and post-incident evaluation processes
- **Managed stakeholder engagement efforts** to align business continuity strategies and operational requirements across diverse cross-functional teams

Program Manager / Major Incident Manager

Amazon | Seattle, WA | May 2017 – July 2021

- **Owned resolution pipelines** for escalated incidents impacting Selling Partners platform, managing technical requirements and cross-functional project delivery while maintaining 99% platform availability
- **Led data-driven postmortem initiatives and reporting analysis**, identifying recurring patterns and reducing incident recurrence by 25% year-over-year through systematic process improvements

- **Designed and implemented instructional programs** impacting 10,000+ internal users, managing project timelines, resource allocation, and delivery milestones with 20% reduction in user errors
- **Championed data-driven decision-making** through embedded performance metrics, comprehensive reporting solutions, and platform engagement optimization
- **Developed operational improvements** to enterprise systems, aligning processes with rapid scaling demands and customer impact prioritization

Account Service Manager (ITIL)

Dell | Mexico | November 2011 – March 2017

- **Delivered end-to-end support** for enterprise systems management including incident, request, problem and change management for financial sector clients during complex cloud migration initiatives
- **Managed infrastructure-driven projects** focused on server provisioning, network configuration, and asset lifecycle optimization with strict budget and timeline adherence
- **Led technical audits and process improvement**, serving as onsite escalation manager and reducing client escalations by 20% year-over-year through systematic workflow enhancements
- **Maintained strong client relationships** through transparent reporting, service delivery excellence, and cross-functional communication between technical and business teams

Technical Trainer & Instructional Designer

Dell | Mexico | April 2009 – October 2011

- **Managed training programs and certification initiatives** for 250+ employees in ITSM processes and enterprise systems, delivering both in-person and virtual training solutions
- **Designed and delivered interactive learning solutions** using data visualization and reporting platforms, creating web-based training based on comprehensive needs assessment
- **Led mentoring programs** supporting employee upskilling and career development while creating supportive networking communities across global teams

Education

- **Master - Information Technology Management**
Universidad Tec Milenio | Mexico
 - **Bachelor of Science, Electronic & Communications Engineering**
Universidad Autonoma de Guadalajara | Mexico
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Certifications

- **ITIL v4 Foundations** – Current best practices in service lifecycle (2024)
- **ITIL v3 Expert Certification** – Comprehensive ITSM mastery across incident, change, and delivery (2011)
- **ITIL Intermediate Specializations** – Operational Support, Service Transition, Continual Service Improvement (2009–2015)

Leadership Style & Innovation Mindset

Gallup [CliftonStrengths](#)® Top 5: Restorative, Harmony, Includer, Relator, and Positivity
Known for building trusted partnerships between technical and business teams, guiding cross-functional initiatives through complex challenges, and delivering consistent results in dynamic environments. Expert at resolving complex technical challenges, building inclusive solutions, and fostering trust through transparent communication and consistent delivery.

AI Integration Experience: Currently leveraging AI tools including Microsoft Copilot, Claude.ai, ChatGPT for enhanced storytelling, presentation development, and dashboard ideation to improve stakeholder communication, data-driven decision making and creating parent engagement initiatives.

Continuous Learning & Professional Development: Currently pursuing advanced certifications and training in AI/ML applications, project management methodologies, product management frameworks, and Azure cloud technologies to stay at the forefront of educational technology innovation and platform development.